

Remote Work Policy Handbook

Northwind Digital Solutions — Effective January 2026

1. Purpose

This handbook defines the standards, expectations, and support structures for employees working outside of a traditional office environment. It applies to all full-time and part-time staff who have been approved for remote or hybrid work arrangements.

2. Eligibility

Employees become eligible for remote work after completing a 90-day probationary period in their role. Eligibility is not automatic; it requires manager approval based on role responsibilities, historical performance, and the nature of the work involved. Customer-facing roles requiring on-site presence, such as front-desk operations, are generally not eligible.

3. Work Schedule and Availability

Remote employees are expected to maintain core availability hours between 10:00 AM and 3:00 PM in their local time zone, during which they should be reachable via Slack or email within 30 minutes. Outside of core hours, employees may arrange flexible schedules with their manager, provided weekly output and meeting commitments are met.

Employees working across time zones more than 4 hours from their team's primary zone must submit a Flexible Schedule Agreement to HR for approval before their first remote month.

4. Equipment and Reimbursement

The company provides a one-time home office stipend of \$750 for new remote employees, covering items such as monitors, ergonomic chairs, and desks. Internet reimbursement is capped at \$50 per month with a submitted receipt. Company-issued laptops remain company property and must be returned within 10 business days of employment ending.

5. Security Requirements

All remote employees must use company-managed VPN software when accessing internal systems. Personal devices may not be used to access customer data under any circumstances. Two-factor authentication is mandatory for all company accounts, and screens must be locked whenever a workstation is unattended, including in home offices.

6. Performance Expectations

Remote work is evaluated using the same performance criteria as in-office work: quality of output, meeting of deadlines, and collaboration effectiveness. Managers conduct monthly one-on-one check-ins, and remote employees receive the same promotion and review timelines as their in-office counterparts.

7. Communication Norms

- Default to asynchronous communication for non-urgent matters.
- Use video calls for discussions requiring nuance or complex decision-making.
- Document decisions made in calls within 24 hours in the shared team wiki.
- Respond to direct messages within one business day, except during approved leave.

8. Termination of Remote Arrangement

The company reserves the right to revoke remote work privileges with 30 days' written notice if performance concerns arise, business needs change, or security policies are repeatedly violated. Employees may also request to return to in-office work at any time by notifying their manager and HR.